



Business Values Lecture: Collaboration, Hard Work, Creativity, and Excellence

【剑桥雅思12 | 听力真题 Test 5 Section 4 | 商业讲座揭秘：协作陷阱·无效勤奋·创意误区·卓越迷思】

Summary: This lecture critiques four commonly accepted business values: collaboration, hard work, creativity, and excellence. It argues that these values can backfire if not properly managed, providing examples of teamwork causing inefficiency, hard work wasting resources, creativity failing to boost sales, and the pursuit of excellence missing market opportunities. The speaker emphasizes the need to apply these values strategically rather than dogmatically.

摘要：本次讲座批判了四种常见的商业价值观：协作、勤奋、创意和卓越。演讲者指出，若管理不当，这些价值观可能适得其反，并通过团队合作降低效率、无效勤奋浪费资源、创意未能提升销量、过度追求卓越错失商机等案例加以论证。强调应战略性地而非教条式地应用这些价值观。



IELTS

听9遍 考9分



🕒 Estimated Reading Time: 9 min.

📖 四级生词 📖 六级生词 📖 雅思生词 📖 托福生词 📖 专八生词 📖 SAT生词 📖 考研生词 📖
GRE生词 📖 高考生词 📖 其它生词

bilibili 00:00:00

🎧 Section 4 You will hear part of a lecture for business students about business values.

第四部分，你将听到一段面向商学院学生的关于商业价值观的讲座。

🎧 First, you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

首先，你有时间看一下第31至40题。

🎧 Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

现在请仔细听并回答第31至40题。

▶ In public discussion of business, we take certain values for granted.

在公开的商业讨论中，我们理所当然地接受某些价值观。

▶ Today, I'm going to talk about four of them.

今天，我将讨论其中的四个。

 00:01:22

▶ Collaboration, hard work, creativity and excellence.

协作、勤奋、创造力和卓越。

▶ Most people would say they're all good things.

大多数人会说这些都是好东西。

▶ I'm going to suggest that's an over-simple view.

我认为这是一种过于简单的看法。

▶ The trouble with these values is that their theoretical concepts removed from the reality of day-to-day business.

这些价值观的问题在于，它们的理论概念脱离了日常商业的现实。

▶ Pursue values, by all means, but be prepared for what may happen as a result.

当然要追求价值观，但要为可能发生的结果做好准备。

 00:01:50

▶ They can actually cause damage, which is not at all the intention.

它们实际上可能造成损害，而这完全不是初衷。

▶ Business leaders generally try to do the right thing, but all too often the right thing backfires if those leaders adopt values without understanding and managing the side effects that arise.

商业领袖通常试图做正确的事，但如果他们在不了解和管理由此产生的副作用的情况下采纳这些价值观，正确的事情往往会适得其反。

▶ The values can easily get in the way of what's actually intended.

这些价值观很容易妨碍实际意图的实现。

 00:02:13

▶ Okay, so the first value I'm going to discuss is collaboration.

好的，我要讨论的第一个价值观是协作。

▶ Let me give you an example.

让我举个例子。

▶ On a management training course I once attended, we were put into groups and had to construct a bridge across a stream using building blocks that we were given.

在我曾经参加的一个管理培训课程中，我们被分成小组，必须用给定的积木搭建一座横跨小溪的桥。

▶ The rule was that everyone in the team had to move at least one building block during the construction.

规则是团队中的每个人都必须在建造过程中至少移动一块积木。

 00:02:41

▶ This was intended to encourage teamwork.

这是为了鼓励团队合作。

▶ But it was really a job best done by one person.

但这实际上是一项最好由一个人完成的工作。

▶ The other teams tried to collaborate on building the structure and descended into confusion with everyone getting in each other's way.

其他团队试图合作搭建结构，结果陷入混乱，大家互相妨碍。

▶ Our team leader solved the challenge brilliantly.

我们的团队领导出色地解决了这个挑战。

🎧 She simply asked everyone in the team to move a piece of few centimeters to comply with the rule and then let the person in the team with an aptitude for puzzles like this build it alone.

她只是要求团队中的每个人都移动一块积木几厘米以遵守规则，然后让团队中擅长这类拼图的人独自完成搭建。

 00:03:12

🎧 We finished before any other team.

我们比其他任何团队都先完成。

🎧 My point is that the task wasn't really suited to team working.

我的观点是这项任务并不真正适合团队合作。

🎧 So why make it one?

那为什么要把它变成团队任务呢？

🎧 Teamwork can also lead to inconsistency, a common cause of poor sales.

团队合作还可能导致不一致，这是销售不佳的常见原因。

🎧 In the case of a smart phone that a certain company launched, one director wanted to target the business market and another demanded it was aimed at consumers.

以某公司推出的一款智能手机为例，一位董事希望瞄准商业市场，而另一位则要求面向消费者。

 00:03:42

🎧 The company wanted both directors to be involved, so gave the product a consumer friendly name, but marketed it to companies.

公司希望两位董事都参与其中，因此给产品取了一个对消费者友好的名字，但却向企业推销。

🎧 The result was that it met the needs of Niser Group.

结果是它满足了Niser集团的需求。

🎧 It would have been better to let one director or the other have his way.

让其中一位董事按自己的方式行事会更好。

▶ Not both.

而不是两位都参与。

▶ Now, industrialism is all hard work.

现在，工业主义就是勤奋工作。

▶ It's easy to mock people who say they work hard.

嘲笑那些说自己努力工作的人很容易。

 00:04:16

▶ After all, a hamster running around in a wheel is working hard and getting nowhere.

毕竟，在轮子上跑来跑去的仓鼠也很努力，但却毫无进展。

▶ Of course, hard work is valuable, but only when properly targeted, otherwise it wastes the resources that companies value most, time and energy, and that's bad for the organisation.

当然，勤奋工作是有价值的，但只有在目标明确的情况下，否则它会浪费公司最宝贵的资源——时间和精力，这对组织不利。

▶ There's a management model that groups people according to four criteria.

有一种管理模型根据四个标准对人进行分类。

 00:04:41

▶ Clever, hard working, stupid, and lazy.

聪明、勤奋、愚蠢和懒惰。

▶ Here, lazy means having a rational determination not to carry out unnecessary tasks.

这里的懒惰意味着理性地决定不执行不必要的任务。

▶ It doesn't mean trying to avoid work altogether.

这并不意味着完全逃避工作。

▶ Most people display two of these characteristics and the most valuable people are those who are both clever and lazy.

大多数人表现出其中的两个特征，而最有价值的人是既聪明又懒惰的人。

▶ They possess intellectual clarity and they don't rush into making decisions.

他们拥有清晰的思维，不会急于做决定。

 00:05:11

▶ They come up with solutions to save the time and energy spent by the stupid and hard working group.

他们提出解决方案，节省愚蠢和勤奋群体花费的时间和精力。

▶ Instead of throwing more man-hours at a problem, the clever and lazy group looks for a more effective solution.

聪明又懒惰的群体不会投入更多工时去解决问题，而是寻找更有效的解决方案。

▶ Next, we come to creativity.

接下来是创造力。

▶ This often works well creating an attention-grabbing TV commercial, for example, might lead to increased sales.

这通常效果很好，例如制作一个吸引眼球的电视广告可能会增加销售额。

 00:05:39

▶ But it isn't always a good thing.

但这并不总是好事。

▶ Some advertising campaigns are remembered for their creativity without having any effect on sales.

一些广告活动因其创意而被记住，但对销售没有任何影响。

▶ This happened a few years ago with the launch of a chocolate bar.

几年前，一款巧克力棒的推出就发生了这种情况。

⏮ Subsequent research showed that plenty of consumers remembered the adverts but had no idea what was being advertised.

随后的研究表明，许多消费者记住了广告，但不知道广告宣传的是什么。

🎵 00:06:01

⏮ The trouble is that the creator derives pleasure from coming up with the idea and wrongly assumes the audience for the campaign will share that feeling.

问题在于创作者从想出的点子中获得快乐，并错误地认为广告的受众也会有同样的感受。

⏮ A company that brings out thousands of new products may seem more creative than a company that only has a few but it may be too creative and make smaller profits.

一家推出数千种新产品的公司可能比只有少数产品的公司看起来更有创造力，但它可能过于创新，利润反而更少。

⏮ Creativity needs to be targeted to solve a problem that the company has identified.

创造力需要有针对性地解决公司已确定的问题。

🎵 00:06:32

⏮ Just coming up with more and more novel products isn't necessarily a good thing.

仅仅推出越来越多新奇的产品并不一定是好事。

⏮ And finally, excellence.

最后是卓越。

⏮ We all know companies that claim they strive for excellence but it takes a long time to achieve excellence.

我们都知道有些公司声称追求卓越，但实现卓越需要很长时间。

⏮ In business, being first with a product is more profitable than having the best product.

在商业中，率先推出产品比拥有最好的产品更有利可图。

⏮ A major study of company performance compared pioneers, that is companies bringing out the first version of a particular product, with followers, the companies that copied and

improved on that product.

一项关于公司业绩的重要研究比较了先驱者（即推出特定产品第一版本的公司）和追随者（即复制并改进该公司的公司）。

 00:07:12

 The study found that the pioneers commanded an average market share of 29%.

研究发现，先驱者平均占据了29%的市场份额。

 While the followers achieved less than half that, only 13%.

而追随者的市场份额不到一半，只有13%。

 Even though their product might have been better.

即使他们的产品可能更好。

 Insisting on excellence in everything we do is time consuming, waste's energy and leads to losing out on opportunities.

坚持在所有事情上都追求卓越既耗时又浪费精力，还会导致错失机会。

 Sometimes second-rate work is more worthwhile than excellence.

有时二流的工作比卓越更有价值。

 00:07:43

 Make sure it's excellent, sounds like a good approach to business but the just-get-started approach is likely to be more successful.

确保它卓越，听起来是一种好的商业方法，但“先行动起来”的方法可能更成功。

 That is the end of section 4.

第四部分到此结束。

 You now have half a minute to check your answers.

现在你有半分钟时间检查答案。

 That is the end of the listening test.

听力测试到此结束。

🎧 In the IELTS test, you would now have 10 minutes to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

在雅思考试中，你现在有10分钟时间将答案誊写到答题纸上。

